

Elevator pitch

An elevator pitch is a prepared self-introduction that says a great deal about you and your company in very few words – or in the time it takes you to go from the bottom to the top of a building in an elevator (or a lift)! It should grab the audience's attention and lead to follow-up questions and a conversation. This "power statement" is as indispensable as a business card and is also a very effective networking tool. Try to have several variations on hand for different situations.

TIPS

- Research your audience and the event you will be attending.
- Identify unique aspects of your business or job to hook the listeners.
- Jot your elevator pitch down in conversational language.

Template

Before preparing your elevator pitch, identify your role and determine the context and purpose of the gathering.

My role is ...

The context / venue is a / an ...

The purpose of the gathering is to ...

Who am I? Make an interesting and dynamic statement about what you do / your company does.

My name is (both names) / I am a(n) / the (job title) at (company) / I am based in ... / I am a link in the global logistics chain ... / We provide peace of mind for ... / By that I mean, ...

What does my company offer? What problem does it solve?

Say what is unique or special about your products / services.

We help businesses to tell their stories to the people who need to hear them ... /

We provide a way out for small businesses struggling with bureaucracy ... /

We are the people to call when there is a crisis ... / We deliver solutions ...

What can I do personally?

My specific area of expertise is ... / This is where I come in ... / I can ease the burden of ...

(Optional)

What should the person I am speaking to do next?

Perhaps you would like to come and see us some time. / Would you like to set up an appointment? /

Could you possibly pass on my details / refer me to ...?